bluntly my head was on the chopping block. But I sincerely meant every word that was written. I survived, but only because we worked very hard and performed, and the results did the speaking.

Unlike movies or fiction where the underdog is romanticized, one should always endeavour to be the top dog in combat or for that matter while facing any challenge in life. In the business of war stakes are very high so there is no question of taking any chances. Having been a 'team man' all my life, I have always believed in delegating responsibility, as it is humanly impossible to do everything oneself. Having spelt out the aim clearly, most of the routine tasks are delegated by me to subordinates (about 80 per cent of the total), whereas a close watch and tight control is kept on few selected activities which would have a major impact on the success of the mission. Thus, the substantive issues remain under my watch. I have never believed in the 'zero error' syndrome, as mistakes are bound to happen and I didn't lose my sleep on some issues that went wrong. In this manner, a tension-free atmosphere was created where the subordinates were given the latitude to use initiative. I believe in the directive style of command and the performance of my team has mostly been beyond my expectations. As one goes higher in rank one has to be a visionary, a lion-hearted and compassionate leader – an 'asli jarnail', a true general officer. On the other hand, there are senior commanders who carry out umpteen rehearsals for any major event, and they personally ensure that even dinner menus are microscopically examined and rehearsed. They also tell the juniors how to do the assigned tasks. How on earth would these leaders have any time or enthusiasm left for looking at the macro-issues or for thinking ahead? In the same breath, what would their subordinates do in a war? There are some commanders who terrorise their subordinates. Such units do not have to hunt for terrorists as 'one' is commanding them! Haven't we seen such leaders?

No military leader can achieve greatness without being original, innovative and unpredictable. To follow the beaten path is pedestrian. Unless we take the adversary off guard, we cannot expect outstanding results. In fact, this approach will get us our